# COMPUTER SYSTEM MAINTENANCE

# Form One – Teacher's Teaching Guide

Based on Chapter Six, printed pages 104–124 of the supplied textbook.

## 7. Types of Computer System Maintenance

| Type | Simple meaning | Simple example |
|---|---|---|
| Preventive maintenance | Work done to prevent problems before they happen. | Cleaning dust and updating software. |
| Corrective maintenance | Work done to fix a problem after it happens. | Replacing a faulty motherboard or hard disk. |
| Routine maintenance | Regular checks and tasks done at planned times. | Checking fans, disks, updates and backups. |

**Memory trick:** Preventive = before the problem. Corrective = after the problem. Routine = regularly.

## 8. Hardware Preventive Maintenance

Hardware preventive maintenance is proactive care of physical computer parts. It helps prevent problems and keeps the computer working properly.

**Examples:** airflow management, power condition checking, hard-drive health assessment, temperature monitoring and cleaning.

## 9. Important Safety Rules

• Switch off and unplug the computer before internal maintenance.
• Use an anti-static wrist strap when handling sensitive components.
• Keep liquids away from electronic components.
• Do not use excessive force on RAM, cables or connectors.
• Ask the teacher before replacing hardware or changing BIOS settings.

## 10. Practical Work

**Motherboard cleaning:** Prepare a clean workspace, disconnect power, use ESD protection, open the case carefully, remove loose dust with suitable tools, inspect the board, allow it to remain dry, then reconnect components correctly.

**RAM cleaning:** RAM is sensitive. Cleaning should only be done when necessary and under teacher supervision. Handle the module carefully and avoid touching sensitive contacts.

**Software maintenance:** Keep software updated, make backups, scan for malware and remove unnecessary files.

**Routine maintenance:** Disk Cleanup, appropriate drive optimisation, checking disks for errors, checking fans and monitoring system performance.